PRELIMINARY EXPERT RESEARCH MEMORANDUM / REVIEW COPY

SidePrize d/b/a PrizePicks, Assignee of Richard Baccellieri v. Vetnos,

A public analysis of the filed complaint reports that SidePrize seeks correction of inventorship of thirteen patents, contending that Richard Baccellieri made substantial contributions to conception of claimed fixed-odds, skill-based fantasy-sports systems and methods. It describes the asserted technical setting as fixed-odds payouts, balanced player-v-player matchups, and associated computer systems, rather than a conventional pari-mutuel fantasy contest.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-24	U.S. District Court for the Southern District of New York	1:26-cv-07225	Patent Inventorship Correction

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

01 / MATTER VERIFICATION AND ASSESSMENT

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	SidePrize LLC d/b/a PrizePicks, Assignee of Richard Baccellieri v. Vetnos, LLC
FORUM / DOCKET	U.S. District Court for the Southern District of New York / 1:26-cv-07225
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-24 / patent inventorship correction
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

The public docket identifies SidePrize LLC d/b/a PrizePicks, Assignee of Richard Baccellieri, and Vetnos, LLC; docket number 1:26-cv-07225; filing date August 24, 2026; S.D.N.Y.; Nature of Suit Patent; and cause of action 35 U.S.C. § 256. It records Jesse Panuccio as the filer of the complaint and of the August 25 pro hac vice materials. The filing lists thirteen patent exhibits and a Baccellieri assignment exhibit.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Jesse Panuccio - Outside counsel, Boies Schiller Flexner LLP. The public docket identifies Panuccio as the filer of the complaint and subsequent pro hac vice materials. Treating the opening filer as a potential purchaser is an analytical inference, not a verified purchasing decision.

jpanuccio@bsfllp.com - publicly printed in the linked professional source; not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

A public analysis of the filed complaint reports that SidePrize seeks correction of inventorship of thirteen patents, contending that Richard Baccellieri made substantial contributions to conception of claimed fixed-odds, skill-based fantasy-sports systems and methods. It describes the asserted technical setting as fixed-odds payouts, balanced player-v-player matchups, and associated computer systems, rather than a conventional pari-mutuel fantasy contest.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary public-source issue map. The filed complaint and patent claims, contemporaneous conception evidence, inventor testimony, prosecution record, and discovery—not this packet—must control any inventorship opinion. Open public synopsis

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Claim-by-claim conception

What specific technical features of the thirteen patent claims were allegedly conceived by Baccellieri, and were those features more than an implementation or reduction-to-practice contribution?

Potential evidence: Claim charts, patent specifications, provisional materials, design documents, source-code history, presentations, emails, and inventor testimony.

02 Fixed-odds game mechanics

How do the claimed systems form player matchups, establish fixed payouts, and maintain a balanced or generally equally probable contest; and which asserted technical features are common across the families?

Potential evidence: Patent claims and figures, historical product specifications, game-rule documentation, probability models, databases, and system demonstrations.

03 Algorithmic risk and probability modeling

What inputs, forecasts, odds, constraints, or balancing rules are needed to generate the claimed outcomes, and do the alleged conception materials disclose the operative technical solution?

Potential evidence: Model notebooks, historical data schemas, risk-engine design records, simulations, source code, release records, and contemporaneous communications.

04 Server and data-flow architecture

Which components obtain real-world sports information, generate matchups, present fixed-payout offers, receive player selections, and determine results; and when did those components or their claimed combination originate?

Potential evidence: Architecture diagrams, API and data-provider records, database schemas, server logs, code repositories, product roadmaps, and technical testimony.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Historical system versions and corroboration

Can contemporaneous technical artifacts distinguish an original inventive contribution from later engineering, routine implementation, or hindsight reconstruction?

Potential evidence: Version-control history, dated prototypes, demos, source-file metadata, archived websites, third-party development records, and authorship evidence.

06 Technical distinctiveness across the families

Do the thirteen patents claim a single technical concept or materially distinct contributions requiring separate inventorship analysis?

Potential evidence: Family trees, prosecution histories, claim comparisons, specifications, inventor declarations, and expert claim-feature matrices.

03 / POTENTIAL EXPERTS

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Jeffrey W. Ohlmann

Associate Professor of Business Analytics, University of Iowa

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for sequential decision-making under uncertainty, sports analytics, and the algorithmic design of fantasy-sports selection systems.

RELEVANT WORK

The University of Iowa reports that Ohlmann studied sports-league drafts and developed algorithmic tools for fantasy-football and baseball drafting; it describes his work as sequential decision-making under uncertainty.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Draft-selection and sports-analytics work is closer to forecasting/optimization than to a full fixed-odds wagering-platform architecture.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | jeffrey-ohlmann@uiowa.edu | public email source

02 Mark E. Glickman

Senior Lecturer in Statistics, Harvard University; Director of Master's Study and Joint Director of Graduate Studies

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for probabilistic rating systems, paired-comparison models, sports analytics, and prediction of competitive outcomes.

RELEVANT WORK

Harvard lists his research interests as statistical methods in games and sports and Sports Analytics Lab; its 2026 reporting describes his current work on statistical systems for estimating win, loss, and draw probabilities.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His expertise is statistical modeling of games and sports, not necessarily implementation of commercial DFS software.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | glickman@stat.harvard.edu | public email source

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Mark N. Broadie

Carson Family Professor of Business and Chair of Decision, Risk, and Operations, Columbia Business School

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for quantifying performance, uncertainty, risk, and sports-analytics methods relevant to fixed-payout and matchup-balancing concepts.

RELEVANT WORK

Columbia identifies his research interests as quantitative finance, risk analysis, and sports analytics; it offers a current Sports Analytics course taught by Broadie and identifies its use of analytical methods in sports and card games including blackjack and poker.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Sports-analytics record is substantial but centered publicly on performance/risk analytics rather than DFS product provenance.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | mnb2@gsb.columbia.edu | public email source

04 Ronald J. Yurko Jr.

Assistant Teaching Professor, Carnegie Mellon University Department of Statistics & Data Science; Director, Carnegie Mellon Sports Analytics Center

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for contemporary sports-data pipelines, machine-learning inference, reproducible metrics, and evaluating data-driven player or game models.

RELEVANT WORK

Carnegie Mellon identifies him as CMSAC director and describes research at the interface of inference and machine learning for sports analytics; the Center publicly identifies sports outcome models, player evaluation, game strategy, and rankings among its research topics.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Teaching-professor appointment and sports-specific research may be less suited to historical patent-conception testimony without additional patent-inventorship expertise.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | ryurko@stat.cmu.edu | public email source

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Michael P. Wellman

Professor of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, University of Michigan

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for computational game theory, multi-agent systems, empirical game-theoretic analysis, simulation, and decision-making under uncertainty.

RELEVANT WORK

Michigan describes his group as using game theory, simulation, machine learning, and empirical methods to analyze complex strategic environments; his published work addresses empirical game-theoretic analysis and market-based scheduling games.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The fit is strongest for game theory and simulation, rather than the particular historical engineering record of the asserted fantasy-sports platform.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | wellman@umich.edu | public email source

06 Dimitris Bertsimas

Vice Provost for Open Learning and Boeing Professor of Operations Research, MIT

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for optimization, stochastic processes, machine learning, robust decision-making, risk management, and reconstructing the technical content of an algorithmic system.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT lists his research interests as optimization, applied probability, risk management, and machine learning and records more than 300 published papers on his public site.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad optimization expertise, but no specific publicly located DFS or fantasy-sports implementation work in this review.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | dbertsim@mit.edu | public email source

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 John Guttag

Dugald C. Jackson Professor of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering, MIT; CSAIL principal investigator

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for software-system implementation, machine learning, technical provenance, and sports analytics.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT CSAIL reports research and publications in machine learning, AI, software engineering, hardware verification, financial analytics, and sports analytics.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His publicly described sports work is broad; the record reviewed does not establish expertise in fixed-odds fantasy-game economics specifically.

Source 1

Draft email | guttag@csail.mit.edu | public email source

08 Cynthia Rudin

Gilbert, Louis, and Edward Lehrman Distinguished Professor of Computer Science, Duke University; Director, Interpretable Machine Learning Lab

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for interpretable predictive models, explaining model logic, feature/decision-rule reconstruction, and separating a claimed algorithmic concept from opaque implementation descriptions.

RELEVANT WORK

Her Duke profile describes research in interpretable machine learning, decision lists, decision trees, additive models, and transparent model design.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Methodological ML expertise may require pairing with a gaming-domain or software-architecture expert.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | cynthia@cs.duke.edu | public email source

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Anil Aswani

Associate Professor of Industrial Engineering and Operations Research, UC Berkeley

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for data-driven behavioral models, optimization, game-theoretic modeling, statistical learning, and evaluation of system-level algorithmic design.

RELEVANT WORK

Berkeley describes Aswani's research as statistical and optimization methods using big data to model complex systems, with explicit research areas including game-theoretic modeling and visual analytics.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No specific public research located on fantasy-sports software or patent-inventorship disputes.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | aaswani@berkeley.edu | public email source

10 Andrew Gelman

Higgins Professor of Statistics, Columbia University; Founding Director, Applied Statistics Center

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for Bayesian statistical inference, multilevel models, uncertainty analysis, and evaluating the assumptions and evidentiary robustness of historical probability or forecasting models.

RELEVANT WORK

Columbia identifies his research in statistical inference, computation, and graphics; his current CV identifies his role as Higgins Professor and founding director of the Applied Statistics Center.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No specific public litigation engagement is asserted from this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

General statistical-methodology fit rather than demonstrated fantasy-sports product development or inventorship practice.

Source 1 | Source 2

Draft email | gelman@stat.columbia.edu | public email source

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.

- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.

- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.

- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

Schedule a 15-minute conversation

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: https://dockets.justia.com/docket/new-york/nysdce/1%3A2026cv07225/671212

Public professional email source: https://www.bsfllp.com/people/jesse-panuccio/

Public technical context source: https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/nysd/1%3A26-cv-07225/doc/analysis/1

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary public-source issue map. The filed complaint and patent claims, contemporaneous conception evidence, inventor testimony, prosecution record, and discovery—not this packet—must control any inventorship opinion.

No attorney or expert was contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts were not checked.